# The Family's Path

*What a family receives, in what order, and what is still missing · spiral edition*

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# The Family's Path - what a family and a learner receive, and in what order

**Status:** v0.1 working draft, authored 2026-09-26. A sequence and a gap map, not a new design. Everything here was decided in the three 8-voice sittings of 2026-09-24 and 2026-09-25; this document only puts the pieces in order and marks which ones do not exist yet. **Companions:** `2027-2028-launch-pad-first-cohort-conversation-v0.1.md` (the door), `launch-pad-promotion-and-the-not-shown-wall-v0.1.md` (what may be shown), `launch-pad-the-ballast-and-open-days-v0.1.md` (the waiting learner), `launch-pad-STATUS-AND-HANDOFF.md` §5 (the owed writing list).

*Not convened as a fourth meeting. Sequencing decisions the room already made is execution, and a fourth sitting on the same program in three days would be the articulateness pattern both Cura and Naomi watch for. The standing conditions still govern every piece below: Chekov on access, Kira on plain language, Accord on the exhale, Comes on the walk.*

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## Three rules that set the order

1. **The limits arrive before the invitation.** The access statement, the cost, the exit, and the removal policy are published before a family is ever asked to be interested. A family that reads them and steps away has been served well. Consent that hides its limits is not consent.
2. **Nothing arrives that assumes a yes not yet given.** No notebook before a seat. No Ballast before a place on the list. No Charter before a conversation.
3. **The learner gets their own copies.** Almost everything at the door is written to a parent. The learner chooses the mode of their own conversation, gives their own yes a week later, and is the person the three years happen to. They should have read things themselves, in their own hands, not filtered.

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## The path

Status key: **HAVE** exists and is usable · **HAVE (cut)** exists but needs a family-facing version pulled out of an internal doc · **MISSING** does not exist

## Stage 0 - Published, before anyone raises a hand

*A family should be able to rule themselves in or out without ever talking to Erin.*

| Piece | Status | Where it is / what it needs |
|---|---|---|
| The Launch Pad Story poster and one-pager | **HAVE** | `portfolio/20-*.pdf` |
| **What it costs** | **MISSING** | No Launch Pad document names a number. The year plan says "Erin sets the real local number." This is the second question every family asks. Jenna and Wes hold the price |
| The access statement (what one guide can hold, what they cannot, who we point you toward) | **MISSING** | Owed since Ring 3. Chekov's condition: no conversation happens before it exists |
| The one-page Family note (what this is and is not, how you leave, how removal works, the appeal path) | **MISSING** | Owed in the handoff §5, item 3 |
| The fit signs, in plain language | **HAVE (cut)** | Door doc §2. Needs a one-page family-facing version |

## Stage 1 - The letter

| Piece | Status | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| The invitation letter, Erin's voice | **HAVE** | Promotion doc §5. Carries or points at all of Stage 0 |
| Kira plain-language and interpreter read | owed | Standing condition |
| Accord exhale read | owed | Standing condition |

## Stage 2 - On interest, before any conversation

| Piece | Status | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| The three lesson plan books, printed | **HAVE** | `portfolio/10-*.pdf`, 76 pages, verified free of fleet names. The strongest thing we have: a parent reads what their kid will do and the kid reads the same pages |

| Piece | Status | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| **What a Tuesday actually looks like, one page** | **MISSING** | The hour-by-hour grid exists inside the internal year plan. It is the single most concrete thing a teenager wants and it cannot be handed over as-is |
| **The year calendar** | **MISSING** | Dates exist in the year plan (Aug 16 opens, seven sessions, Open Waters to late May). A family needs term dates, breaks, the harvest dates and the feast on one printed page |
| **The FAQ** | **MISSING** | College, a diploma, sports, what if my kid hates it, what if we move, can they do this and part-time school. Its hardest question is the transcript, and the design already says name a dual-enrollment owner and make the first CWI or BSU call |
| **A learner-facing page** | **MISSING** | Everything above is addressed to a parent. What this is, what we look for, what you can say no to, how the conversation works, in the learner's hands |

## Stage 3 - The evening in the room

| Piece | Status | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| The evening, designed | **HAVE** | Promotion doc §3: the settle, a choice game, the Table, the refusals read aloud, no learners present |
| **The run sheet** | **MISSING** | Designed but not written as something to hold. Accord owes the exhale read on it |
| The mode menu, handed to the learner | **HAVE** | Door doc §3.1. The learner chooses, so the learner receives it |
| Low-sensory seat, written version of everything said | room property | Chekov's condition, built in rather than offered on request |

## Stage 4 - The two conversations

| Piece | Status | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| The learner conversation, shape and questions | **HAVE** | Door doc §3, questions rewritten direct 2026-09-26 |
| The family conversation | **HAVE** | Door doc §4, including the three parent refusals |
| **The guide's card** | **MISSING** | One page to hold in the room: the pass sentence, the shape, the questions, the eight fit signs marked yes, no or not seen. The second adult countersigns |

## Stage 5 - The week alone

| Piece | Status | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| The learner's own yes | no document, deliberately | Asked a week later, alone, in any medium. Led by the second adult where §8 applies |

## Stage 6 - The reply, in writing, within two weeks, to every family

| Piece | Status | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| **The yes letter** | **MISSING** | The seat, the start date, the Charter to countersign, and "you can still say no" |
| **The "we can't hold this" letter** | **MISSING** | The honest reason tied to the access statement plus a real named referral. Accord reads it before any send |
| **The "not this year" letter** | **MISSING** | The reason, a place on the list, a real next door. Never "not you" |

## Stage 7 - On a yes

| Piece | Status | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| **The Family Charter and Enrollment Covenant, countersigned** | **MISSING** | Pilot runs on the one-page Family note; the full Charter is P1 and goes to counsel |

| Piece | Status | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| The Ballast, if they are waiting a season | **HAVE** | `launch-pad-the-ballast-and-open-days-v0.1.md`. Free, four items, no guide obligation |

### Stage 8 - Day one

| Piece | Status | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| Captain's Log, 100 Dreams card, Year-Map, Weekly Plan pad, Five-Region map | **HAVE (spec)** | Session 1 materials list. Print and buy before Aug 16 |
| The Two-Way Deal: the six refusals read as a promise, then the tribe co-writes its agreements | **HAVE** | Session 1 day-by-day, Day 1 |
| **The learner's own copy of the six refusals, to keep** | **MISSING** | They exist as a Day-1 activity but not as an object the learner holds. "These are promises to you, and you can hold us to them" |

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## What is missing, ranked

Seven of the gaps above are ordinary writing. Three of them block the door.

1. **The cost.** No Launch Pad document names a number, and the door has a hole in the middle without one. Jenna and Wes hold it.
2. **The access statement.** Named as owed in three consecutive sittings. Chekov's condition is binding: no conversation before it exists, because "not a fit" enforced without it is disability screening nobody decided to do.
3. **What happens if something happens to you.** A family committing a child to three years with a solo guide who is pregnant will ask this, and the honest answer today is a document that does not exist. The Successor Envelope is already P0-2, the first item on the handoff's founder list, to be authored while rested and co-signed. It is also the answer to the hardest question at the door.

Then, in rough order of how soon a family will want them: a day on a page; the year calendar; the learner-facing page; the FAQ with a named owner for the dual-enrollment clock; the three reply letters; the guide's card; the evening run sheet; the learner's refusals card.

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## What would support the adventure, beyond the paperwork

Three things the design already names and has not built, which would do more for a family's confidence than any additional document.

- **The named outside adult, on paper.** One external, non-founder, non-parent, non-employee adult, reachable directly by the learner and the family, who can say a binding no the guide cannot overrule. It is already the single consolidated Ring-3 hook. A family reading that sentence in the Family note relaxes in a way no reassurance achieves.
- **The dual-enrollment bridge, with an owner and a clock.** The credential question is the one a parent loses sleep over, and the design says the window closes on a clock nobody owns. One phone call converts the FAQ's weakest answer into its strongest.
- **The Cohort Call, one page.** The consent primitive the cohort uses to decide the things that are theirs, including who sits in their Unveiling. It seats in Origin Session 3, and it is what makes "co-created" true rather than decorative.

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*The limits first, the warmth second, and nothing that assumes a yes the family has not given.*

*"We evoke - we never extract."*